

PIRATES OF TOKYO BAY

パイレーツ・オブ・東京湾

Media Fact Sheet (August 2026)

Laughter beyond the language barrier. English and Japanese improv comedy in Tokyo.

THE BASICS

- ▶ **Founded:** 2010 in Tokyo by American Mike Staffa, as the sister group of Osaka's Pirates of the Dotombori
- ▶ **Position:** Tokyo's longest-running English and Japanese improv comedy group, now in its 16th year with over 500 shows performed in Japan and overseas
- ▶ **Style:** Unscripted short-form improv. Every scene and song is created on the spot from audience suggestions
- ▶ **The hook:** Japanese and English scenes flow through a single show. Pantomime and gibberish keep everything easy to follow, so the show is fun even if you only speak one language
- ▶ **Cast:** 21+ volunteer performers from 12+ countries

SHOWS

- ▶ **Monthly show:** One Sunday every month (January to November) at What the Dickens!, a British pub in Ebisu
- ▶ **Times:** Doors 7:00pm, show 7:30pm
- ▶ **Tickets:** ¥2,500 including your 1st drink, via piratesoftokyobay.com/shows
- ▶ **Venue:** Roob 6 Bldg 4F, 1-13-3 Ebisuunishi, Shibuya-ku, Tokyo 150-0021. A 3-minute walk from Ebisu Station, 1 stop from Shibuya

COMING UP

- Aug 30 (Sun)** Monthly show @ What the Dickens!, Ebisu
- Sep 20 (Sun)** Tokyo International Comedy Festival @ Tokyo Comedy Bar, Shibuya
- Sep 27 (Sun)** Monthly show @ What the Dickens!, Ebisu
- Nov 29 (Sun)** 16th anniversary show @ What the Dickens!, Ebisu

STYLE NOTES FOR WRITERS

"English and Japanese improv comedy"

"No script, no plot, no safety net"

"Fun even if you only speak one language"

"Built entirely from audience suggestions"

Please avoid the word "bilingual." It suggests you need both languages to enjoy the show. You don't, and that word turns away the people who would have the best night.

The venue name is "What the Dickens!" (exclamation mark included).

AWARDS & PRESS

- ▶ **Peatix Community Award 2026:** Creative Arts Community Award, selected from 250+ communities nationwide
- ▶ **TripAdvisor:** 5 stars, ranked #4 in Theater & Concerts in Shibuya
- ▶ **Metropolis Japan:** "The funniest night out for mixed groups of friends in Tokyo!"
- ▶ **KAYAK Tokyo Guide:** Featured in the official travel guide for the Shibuya area

MILESTONES

- ▶ **2012:** Featured at the TED@Tokyo talent search; talks and staff seminars at the US Embassy
- ▶ **2013 onward:** Charity shows with the Over Cancer Together campaign supporting cancer survivors
- ▶ **On tour:** Comedy festivals in Beijing, Hong Kong, Shanghai, Manila, Singapore, Kuala Lumpur, New York, and Hanoi
- ▶ **Corporate training:** Clients include Google Japan, the US Embassy, and BizReach. Director Mike Staffa's courses stream on GLOBIS Unlimited, Japan's largest MBA platform
- ▶ **2024:** Collaboration show with THE EMPTY STAGE, produced by Yoshimoto Kogyo
- ▶ **2026:** 10 new cast members joined from open auditions that drew 75 applicants

MISSION

- ▶ Humor is a powerful bridge between cultures. We build a night out where Japanese locals and international guests laugh together in the same room, something you can only find in Tokyo
- ▶ Beyond shows, we run improv-based corporate training and team building focused on psychological safety, active listening, and adaptability

INTERVIEWS & ASSETS

- ▶ We welcome interviews, filming requests, and article features, in Japanese and English
- ▶ Photos, logos, and full press kits: piratesoftokyobay.com/media
- ▶ Social: Instagram / TikTok / X @piratestokyo, YouTube: TokyoImprov